

CleanMyMac

User Manual

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1. Install CleanMyMac

1. Go to CleanMyMac.com
2. Read the FAQ and explore the features of the software before deciding to purchase.
3. If you're using this manual, you likely have already decided that CleanMyMac is the software for you to optimize your Mac's storage and keep it free of viruses and malware.
4. You can get a free-trial and use the software for 7 days if you want to try it out before investing in the application.
5. Click "Buy Now" (*fig. 1.1*)

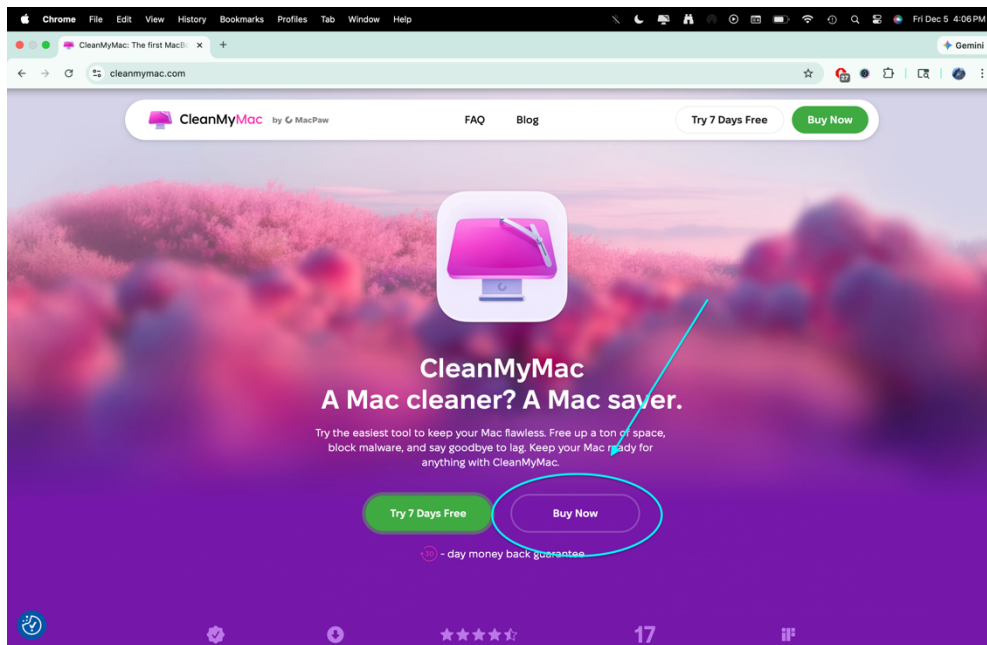


fig. 1.1

6. You'll then enter this screen (*fig 1.2*). For purposes of this guide, we recommend a basic annual plan. If you're committed to the software, you can pay a one time fee, but I recommend using it for 3-4 months before deciding on a complete purchase. An annual subscription will give you the operational utility and flexibility to use the software for all your technological optimization needs.

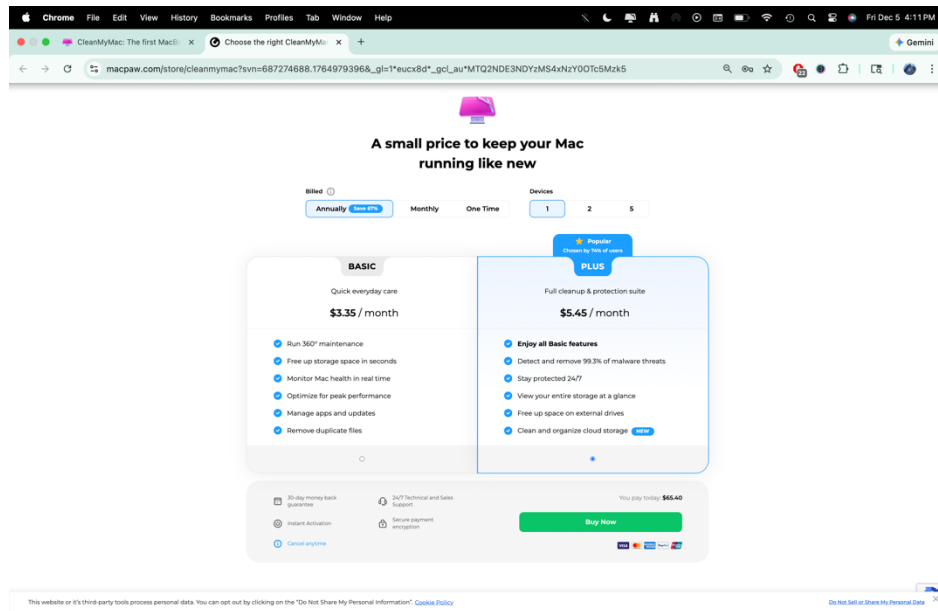


fig. 1.2

7. Proceed to the payment screen and enter your credit card details and information to make the purchase.

8. Installation should be simple enough, if you've ever installed something on your Mac. Go to your downloads folder and open up CleanMyMacX.dmg. When the next window opens, drag the CleanMyMac icon to the Applications folder icon (*fig 1.3*). Wait for the software to install. Then open it and grant necessary permissions that the software. The app is going to ask permission for full disk access, configuring system extensions, and using optimization tools in simultaneity with your system. To grant these permissions go to:

System Settings (*fig. 1.4*) → Privacy & Security → Full Disk Access → Flip the slider switch to “on” (blue) for CleanMyMac



fig. 1.3



fig. 1.4

2. Open the software

Enter full screen mode. You should see a screen like this once the software is all installed and ready to be used (*fig 2.1*).

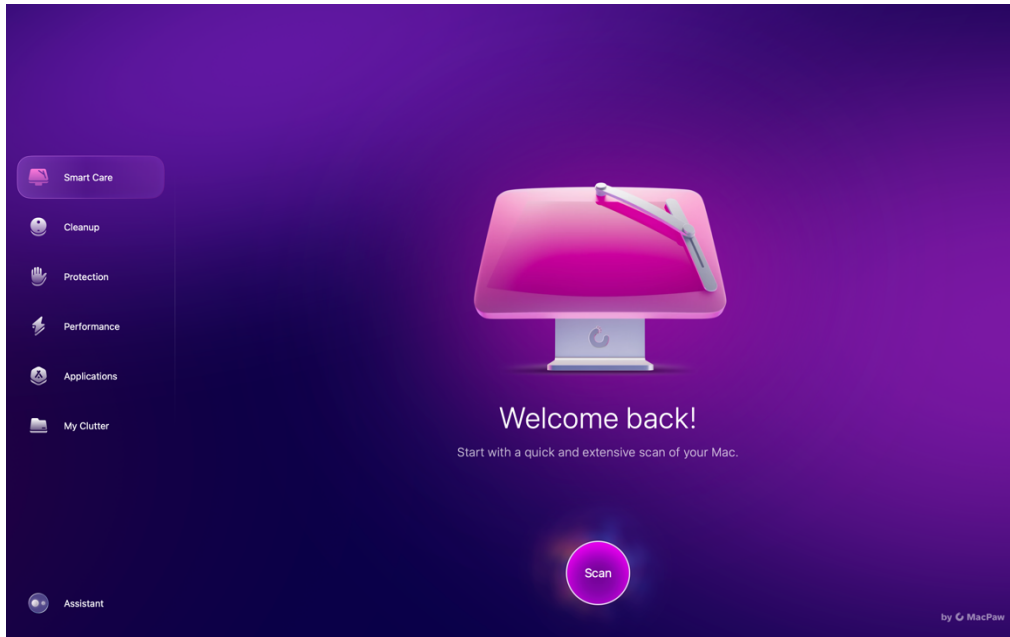


fig. 2.1

3. Start with using the **Smart Care** feature

1. Once you hit scan, you should see a screen that looks like this. It contains within it a live time processor with updates of disc directories / file names that the cleaner is sifting through to provide you with the ideal update about how your hard drive is doing. “Cloud Kit” happens to be the file / directory on the screen freeze that is occurring here. Similar “sift through updates” appear in black below the module in which the software appears to be running through directories.

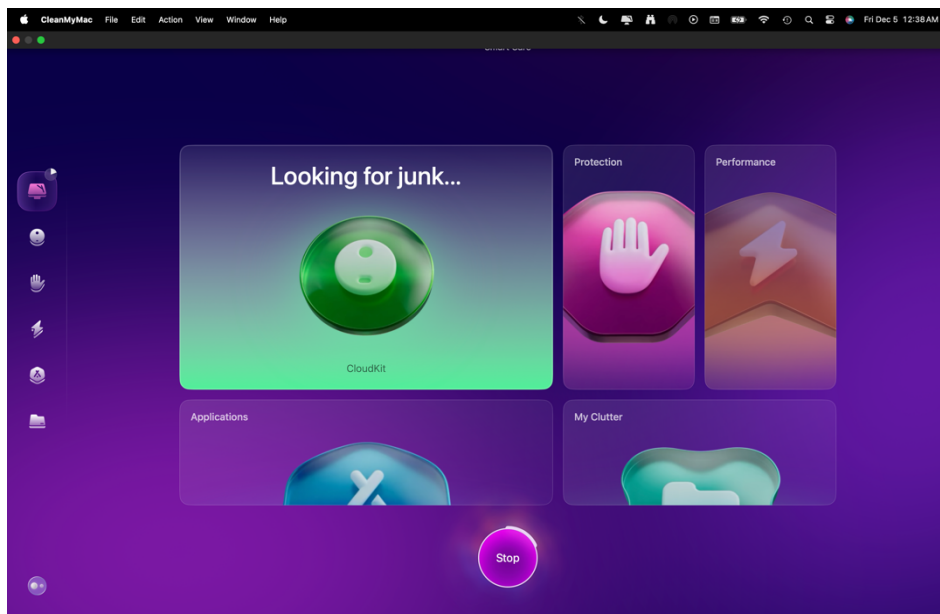


fig. 3.1

2. Once the scan is complete, the software's interface should look like this. As we can see here, on my laptop (MacBook Pro) in its current state, there is 14.2 GB of junk, which thankfully can be reviewed shortly (in the context of the guide) to free up space on my hard drive. Unless your hard drive is almost full, the space on the hard drive itself doesn't actually affect the speed of the laptop which is processed by the CPU (central processing unit), RAM (random access memory), SSD (solid state drive), and GPU (graphics processing unit) components of the M1 pro chip installed on the 2021 model of the MacBook Pro. Depending on your Mac's tech specs, speed can be affected in different ways by different factors. Cleaning your Mac is one way to ensure your computer is running in tip-top shape with ideal speed capability if you are bottlenecked for space. For me today, that is not the case.

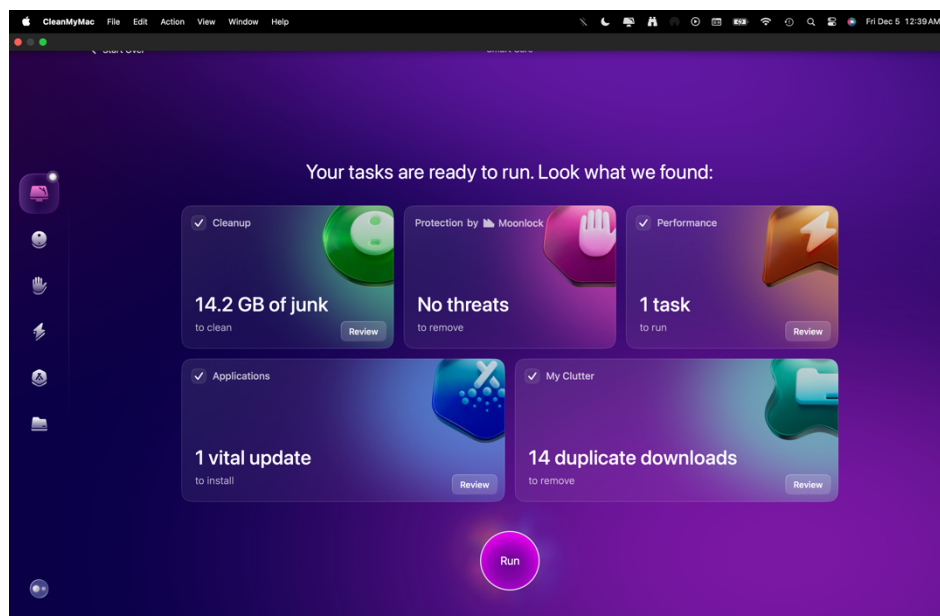


fig. 3.2

3. On the next screen (*fig. 3.3*) we can see user cache files, system cache files, system log files, user log files, and broken log in items.

Cache files are basically temporary data bits that your computer saves to load things faster. They are little shortcuts the system creates to avoid doing the same work repeatedly. Let's click on the Spotify.app right arrow to see what kinds of files we're looking at deleting.

Some of these cache files are unneeded and CleanMyMac does a great job at discerning which cache files are useless for you to clear from your hard drive and allow for new cache pathways to be created to facilitate your use of certain apps / software on your laptop like Spotify. When the engine is looking through files, it does a thorough job in making sure you're not running into valuables.

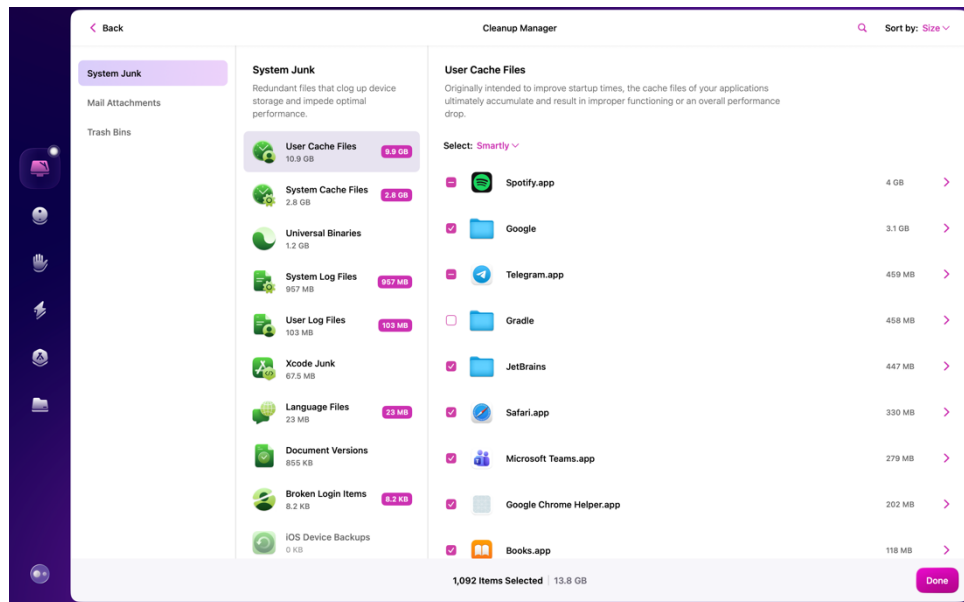


fig. 3.3

4. There's a great description right here (fig. 3.4) of what exactly CleanMyMac is hoping to achieve by clearing out your **cache files** for individual apps on your laptop. You can see the individual folders for all the cache files that are crowding out the application's capacities on your laptop and ultimately hurting its performance. If you're a tech wizard and understand the internal workings of a cache system, then feel free to customize the types of cache files you're deleting from your drive. Otherwise, it's safe to trust that cache files are not important to the inner functioning of a software and can be deleted.

Open cookies are useless, but are stored on your device repeatedly to make sure you can login and have your search queries saved in a way that is intuitive to your use of certain web browsing software. In the case of Spotify, the software and web interface accesses your saved preferences, search queries, and login credentials in a manner that allows for saved cookies. **Cookies** are temporarily (or however long you want them on your drive before hitting delete) stored and can include information such as use history. It is with full certainty, that I declare Spotify's open cookie database to be superfluous data that you won't miss. Any important cookies will still be saved in your keychain, and we speculate that open cookies only refer to cookies that won't be useful to access at a later date.

My particular Mac has a lot of Mail files lying around. This theoretically means I'm drafting a lot of emails and saving lots of attachments from email files such as transcript PDFs, employment information / contracts, as well as audio and video files shared with me.

I discovered CleanMyMac was doing this, as attachments disappeared from within the Outlook type app. They're easy files to relocate via your Internet browser.

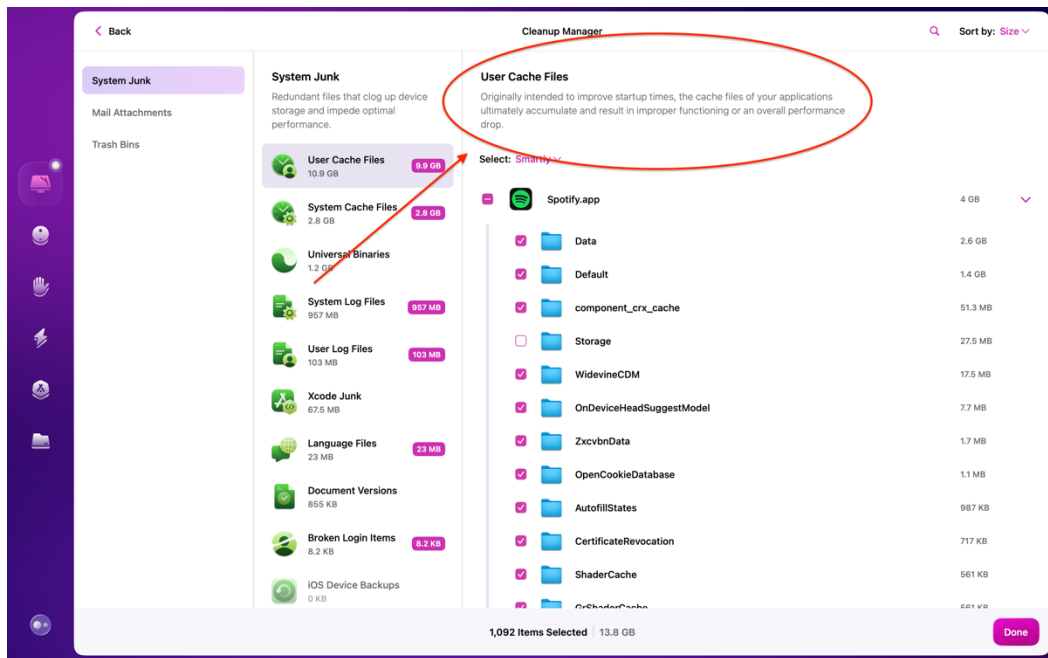


fig. 3.4

5. From this last screen, click Done, and finally, click the “Run” button (fig. 3.5).

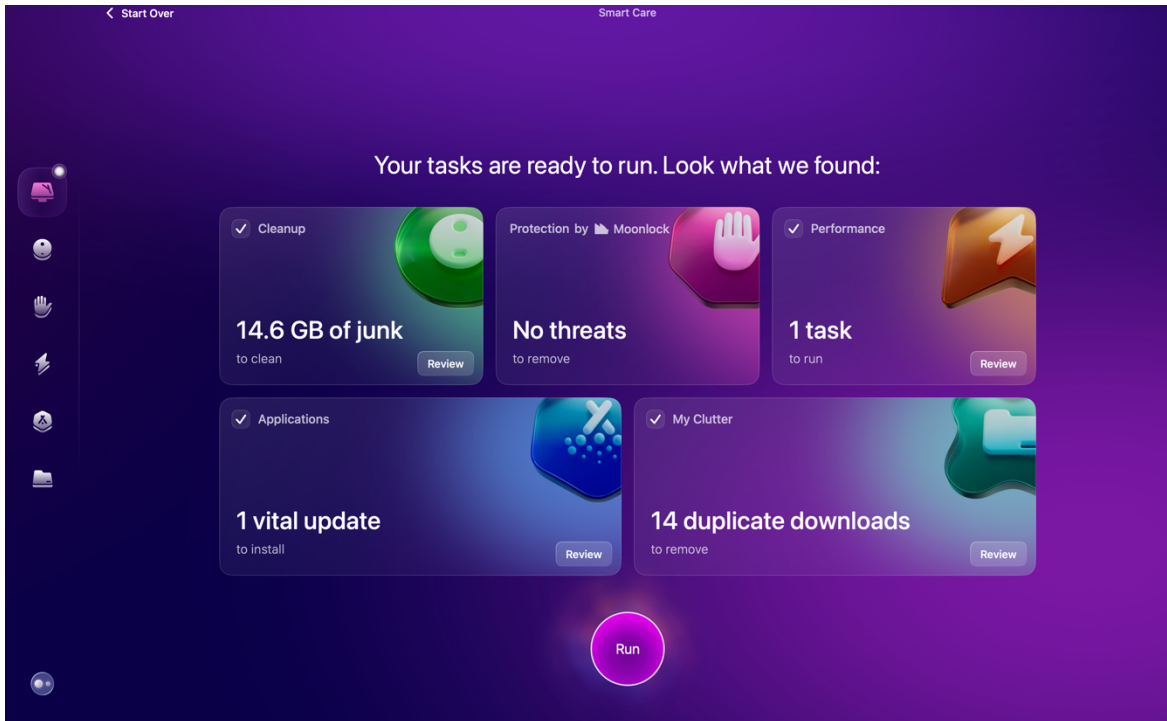


fig. 3.5

6. Click on “Review” one last time. Then click “Run”. Then click “Clean”.

This will clear your disk of its **Recycling Bin** along with any unneeded files. I hope your technological prowess serves you well here. Review your app data carefully. I decribed my disk, but it isn't indicative of all disks. After running the cleaner, I deleted 14.6 GB of stored data within my applications and data logs on my Mac to cleanse the system of its unneeded storage capabilities. You put it in the **Recycling Bin** for a reason. Don't get too clingy of your data anyways.

I did mention cache files and the importance of detecting duplicates in your internal hard drive before proceeding to understand the bulk of the space being taken up on your disk. I've never ran into photography (**iPhoto** content) scanning so that's a plus. Wanna hold on to those camera rolls.

Spotify metadata should be safe to delete too on the grounds that I couldn't possibly delete my playlist data with the click of this button. This would require deeper user permissions from the app itself.

7. We get a “Cleaned” notification from all the tests (checkbox at the bottom of the individual rectangles that says “cleaned”, “No threats to remove”, “Done”, “Started”,

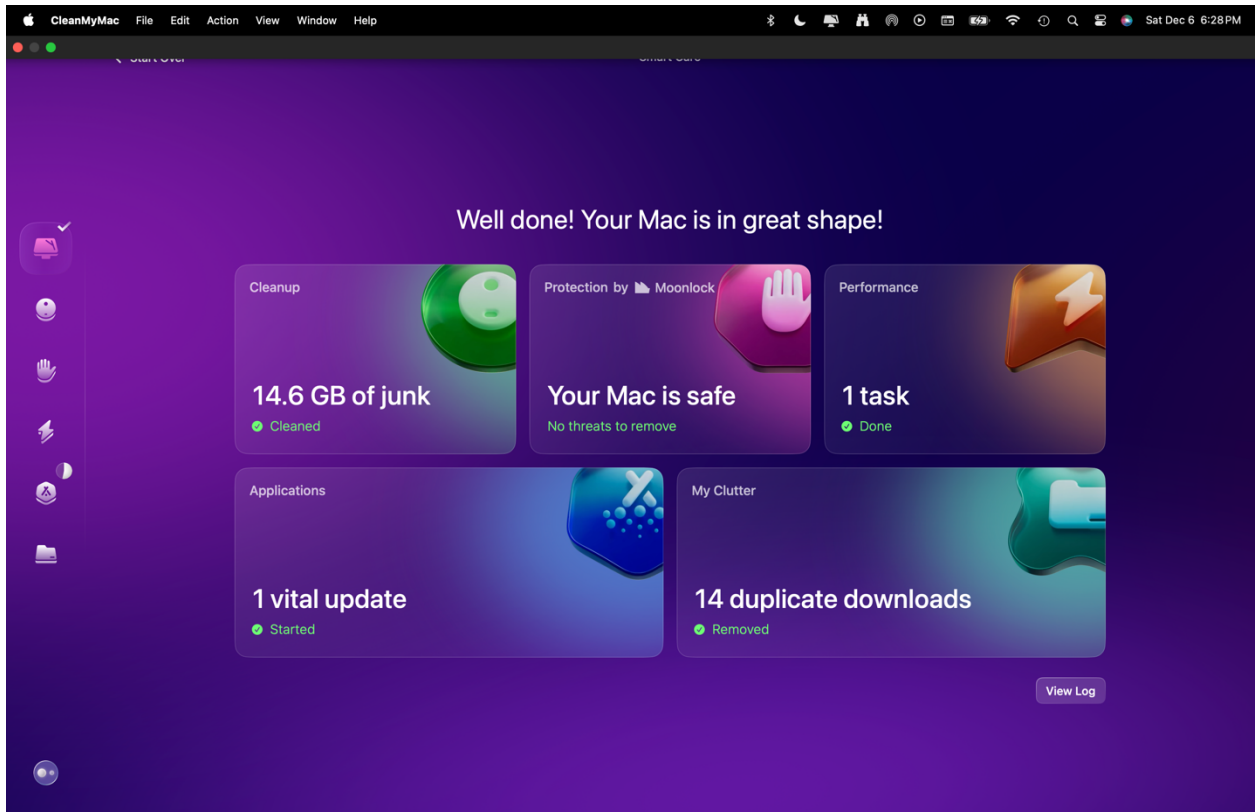


fig. 3.6

“Removed”) (fig. 3.6) and runthroughs the software can take us through before deep cleansing our disk and drowning our tresses in some “shampoo” if you will to cleanse our split-ends and remind us of why in particular that we don’t need to hang on to unneeded space on our precious laptops.

As an aside, I also use external hard drives to offload valuable space, to clear up space on my hard drive. Attaching too much attributed care to something as precious as a small hard drive in a drawer is hard to do. But it’s okay. iCloud backups or home backup servers are a good way of protecting your data too.

Hold on to any prized belongings on your way out to cleaning out your Mac.

Like I mentioned earlier, this kind of deep cleanse can save our system of its eventual decline, and help you power back up if your hard drive is too full. This can be used in rare events like this as a safety protocol or use it like me and run it routinely to clear up space on your hard drive. Just like brushing your teeth. To clarify, as a safety precaution, you wouldn’t want to lose all your data due to a complete system crash, and would need CleanMyMac to help you make space on your drive.

We will be, at brief, discussing some of the other features of CleanMyMac.

Next we move towards **Moonlock Protection**.

You can leave other apps open if you have an M1 chip or higher versioning in completing this task with Google Chrome or Spotify open.

4. Explore **Protection** abilities of the software and scan

1. Zoom into Moonlock Protection by clicking its button on the sidebar. There's no point in adjusting the view of this guy via the ribbon's "View" function at the moment. We need the sidebar there to explore CleanMyMac's endless capabilities. ‘

The clean should have completely removed all malware.

This is a useful screen post, illuminating us to all the threats that were nullified.

A **malware scan** can not only find threats to your laptop's safety, but also preemptively cancel out routes or gateways that a hacker may have in attacking your system with a virus—whether that be through bluetooth, the WIFI network, or a suspicious downloaded package (*fig 4.1*). There are screen sharing hackers out there, who might try and get your identity, if you aren't protective enough. Viruses are hard to catch, but don't go on U Torrent too often either, just to offload your favorite band's music or free movie. That will eventually bring about a virus to your computer or a defect in one of their softwares for not having the money to buy a full version. I've encountered this before, so just be careful

CleanMyMac scanned through 323.6K files to keep your device safe from threats.

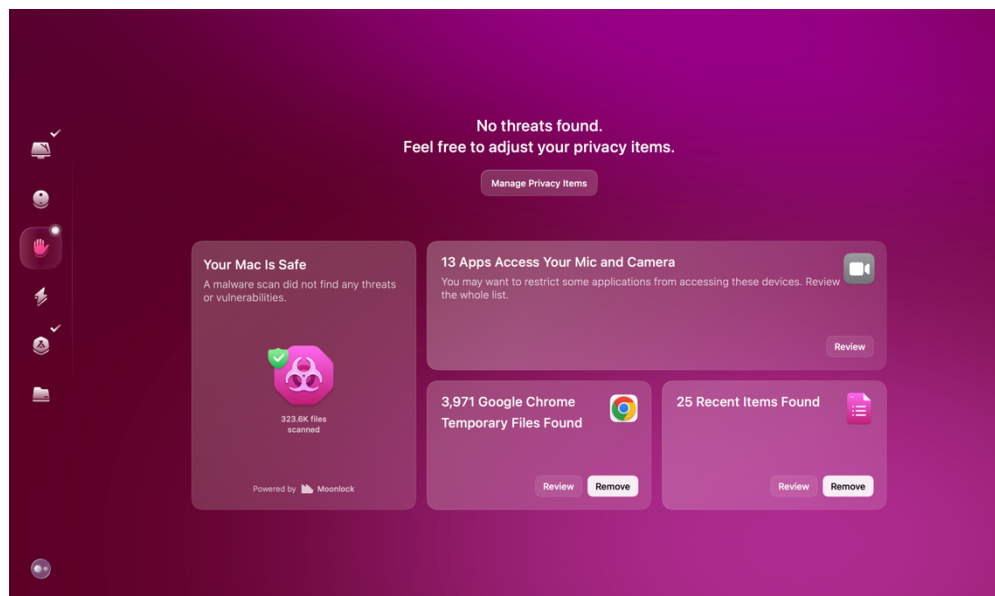


fig. 4.1

2. As a general privacy protection process, CleanMyMac has granted us access to see if any of our software or apps are spying on us without a warrant. Unwarranted soliciting or phishing is sure to bring out the best of you into doing something that you don't want to do. Click on the rectangle in the space on *fig. 4.1* where on my screen "13 Apps Access Your Mic and Camera" is written. Once you've clicked on that rectangle, you'll see a screen that looks much like *fig. 4.2* and allows you to see if any of the big corporations are spying on you for user content development or just swooping by the NSA to make sure everyone's safe. Either Snowden or software engineer in you, shall come along as we zoom to our next entry.

These are just the apps on my laptop. All look safe right?

Make sure unwanted software installations haven't accidentally taken place on your laptop due to a cyber attack or internet exploring mishap. There were sketchy pop-up ads on certain websites in the 90s, beware. Click around on them, and you'd inadvertently let a virus enter your computer.

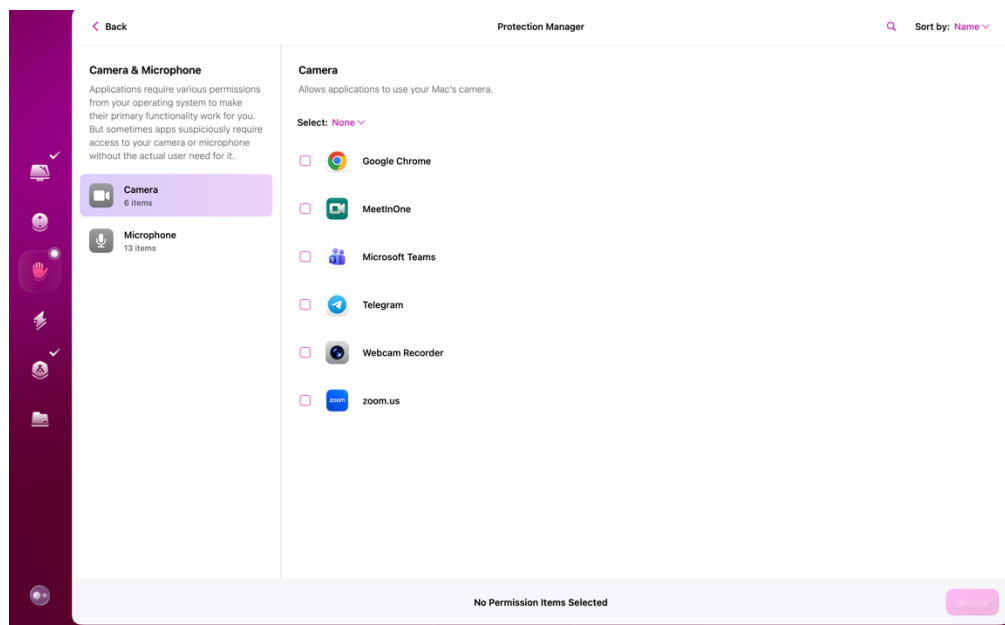


fig. 4.2

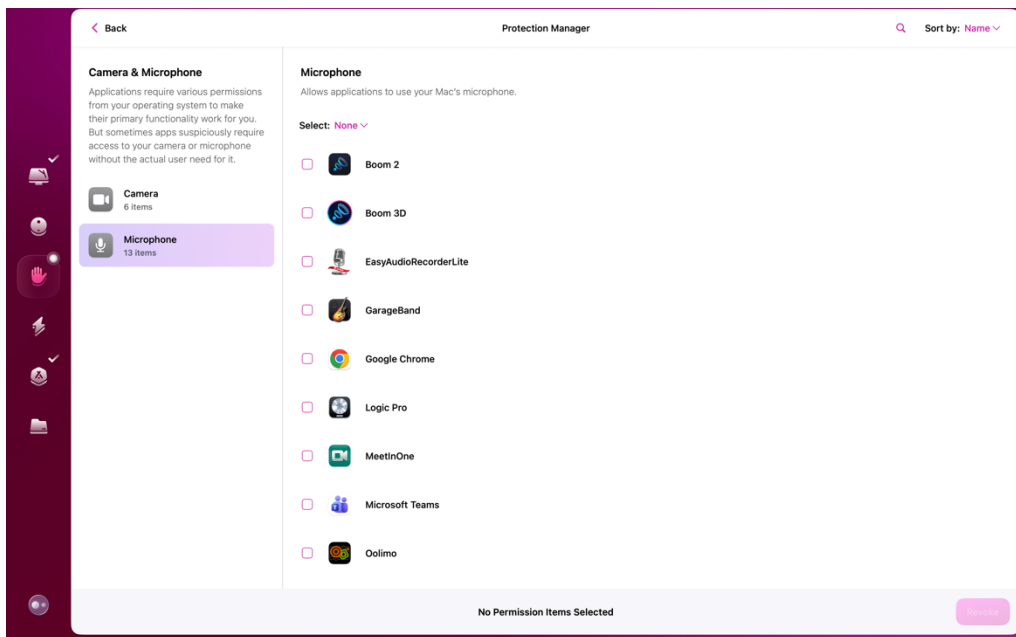


fig. 4.3

If you click on the sidebar and come upon the “Microphone” button, you know that you can then access the slew of apps on *my* laptop using explicit permissions from me to use my hardware (fig. 4.3). If there’s something doing this without you wanting it to, hopefully you’d know by now, but if you didn’t catch it and don’t want that in there, then please feel free to delete the software that doesn’t look like it should have the authority to access your microphone, even consider deleting the app. For example: a video chatting with strangers app that later was found to be too expensive. Oolimo being the most obscure, isn’t stranger software, but instead just a chord finder application to turn your alternate tuning guitar chords into music theory lessons.

Look now back a screen to fig. 4.1 in step 8 of this chapter. The “3971 Google Chrome temporary files found” should be considered now. Consider with me, deleting the temporary files as they are cluttered up on your hard drive, inhabiting potential data pathways and vacancies that security-breachers, hackers, or data-mining viruses may find palatable to consume as branchways to attack your computer like venom. But I digress, it should be okay to delete these files. As it pertains to “Protection” of your computer, and we are in the “Protection” tab, these files pose an immediate threat to the safety of your computer by creating bridges that it’s best to burn. I doubt anyone is trying to attack you via web browser right now though. I mean I’m not a browser hijacker, are you?

It’s helpful to keep adware, trojans in mind, cookie trackers, suspicious configuration user profiles, and suspicious browser extensions as terms that are helpful to know so conceptualize the safety of your device. These are the many ways your device can be attacked from the outside, through pathways a browser like Chrome can create. There are many ways for a virus to make its way onto your computer.

If you're trying to understand how exactly **cybersecurity** works on just one device, trying to protect itself against certain threats as they exist in the cyber world. CleanMyMac can protect you from ransomware, spyware, adware, and botnet, by making sure your device is free of their clutches. CleanMyMac also deals with firewalls and VPNs to protect the passageways through which evil could sift into your wires. There are many different kinds of cyber attacks—that is, they take many forms. Hoping you don't get socially engineered or subject to XSS (cross-site scripting) through your browser connection.

A virus scan is an essential component of endpoint protection and risk management in the realm of cyber-security. The cyber-security of one device is of course a small matter.

Who is head of cyber-security operations at Google?

Google both sculpts useful technologies for others and keeps their own servers safe.

In the technological sphere of bluetooth signals, internet, and wire connections, there are types of filetypes flying around that can potentially harm your device, by running their system configurations through your main frame by using imitation for an attack upon the device's immunity.

Government computers need these safety more than your device does. A cyber attack on an FBI computer, could be extremely classified information. You get the gist.

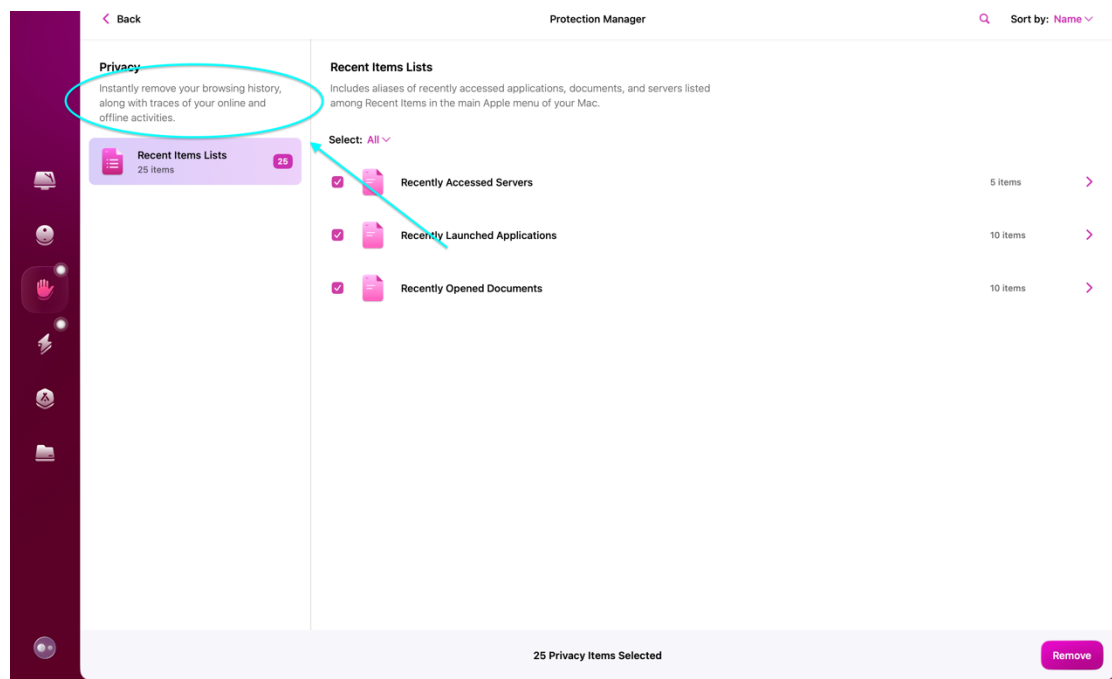


fig. 4.4

Notice under “Privacy” there’s a readup on what exactly the protection manager component in CleanMyMac

In fig. 3.10 we can choose to protect our privacy by deleting all saved impressions of activities we have conducted on the laptop both offline and online. Sometimes privacy is synonymous with protection, as we feel safest when our personal operations, happenings, choices, decisions, words, and laptop activities aren’t being monitored, specially by someone we might not want to be doing this. Is this paranoia?

There’s no thought police or NSA trying to watch you plant a bomb on a local metro train.

We can still feel safest knowing that some of our private activity on the laptop is protected from phishing. Malware can gain access to your accounts and then the more of this kind of data that’s lying around, the more vulnerable you are to infiltration. So click the “**Remove**” button and onwards we go to cleaning our Mac.

The most important thing is that the app says “The Mac is Safe” conducting a malware scan that didn’t find any threats or vulnerabilities.

5. Explore **Performance** enhancing capabilities of the software and scan

1. Click on the sidebar, let's go to "Performance". Here we are in bright orange (*fig. 5.1*).

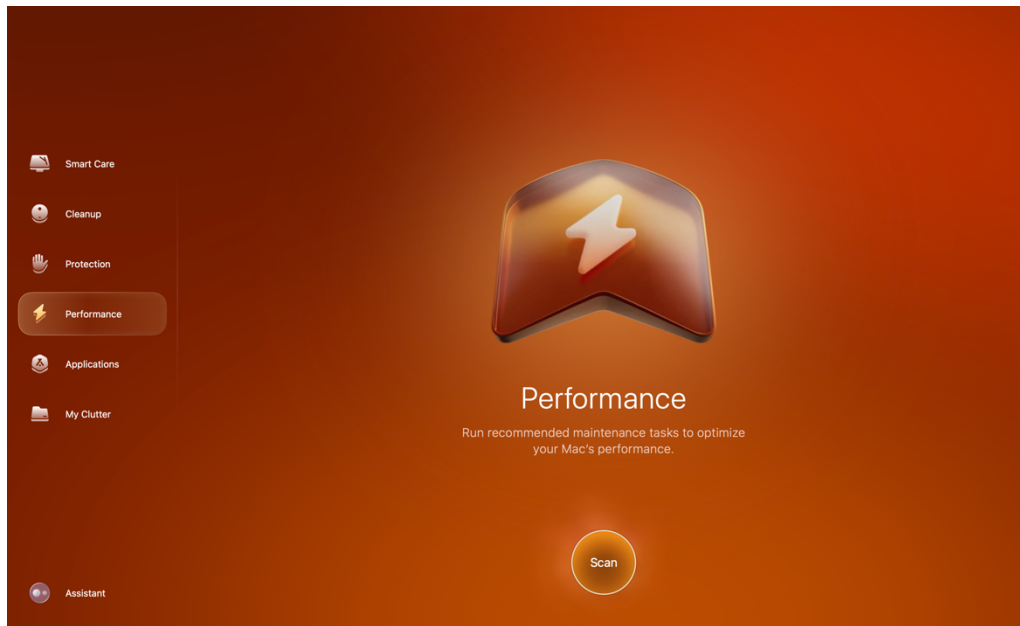


fig. 5.1

Click the glowing red "Scan" button.

Nifty little screen opens up telling you about how your Mac's performance is doing. Performance of the Mac is determinate upon speed, responsivity, and efficiency. CPU, RAM, Storage, and GPU come together to comprise our performance party. CleanMyMac promises to better your computer's performance.

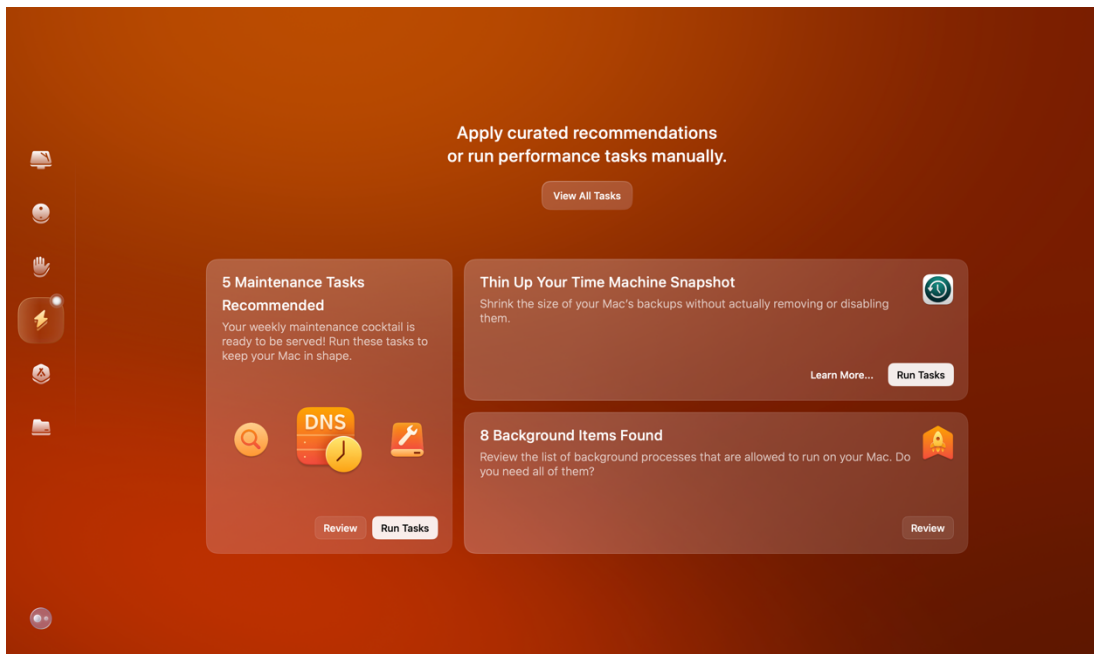


fig. 5.2

2. First when we're checking out this screen (fig. 5.2). Let's get an overview of all the individual modules here in front of us. CleanMyMac has a built-in function to "Thin Up" your Time Machine backup. I backup my computer frequently to iCloud, to my homeserver, and to an external hard drive. I have a sum total of 3 copies of my data around me at any given moment. I'm particular about my data and so should you be. My Dad instilled this in me growing up.

3. Let's check out what my Maintenance Tasks are (*fig. 5.3*)

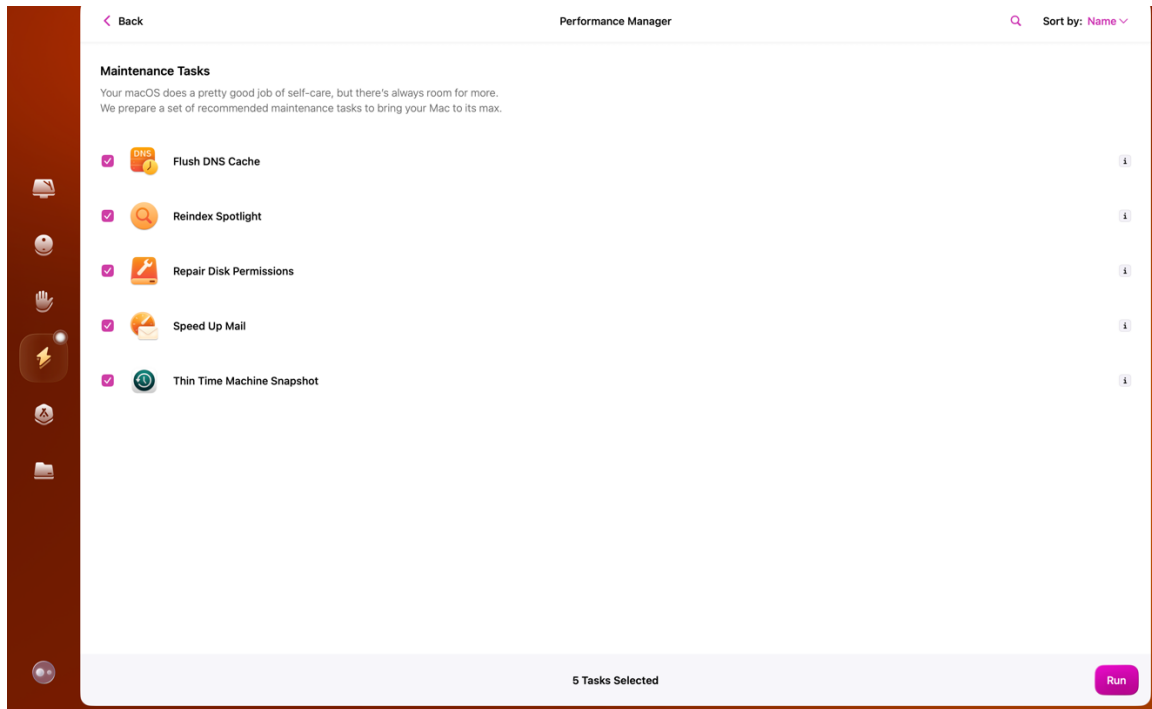


fig. 5.3

Wouldn't it be helpful to run these **Maintenance Tasks** to do things like "Speed Up Mail" and "Repair Disk Permissions". CleanMyMac employs intelligent technologies that allow for system clean throughs with your trust, care and money of course, we're hoping to hold your attention for minutes a month to make sure everything is in tip-top shape on your device. So let's not waste it on deliberating upon speed care efforts that the software is making to refresh your system.

Thinning your **Time Machine Snapshot** by the way is a complicated task accomplished by the engine that is CleanMyMac by making sure that your Time Machine is being a little bit briefer by compressing Mac backup data. To compress the file, the computer is using something like a .zip effort to make the data take up less space, but still contain its entire contents. There are a lot of temporary snapshots stored by Time Machine in between the first and final snapshot. Let's say there's 30 snapshots of your Hard Drive by Time Machine and you only need 5. Segmenting your drive probably means getting rid of this unneeded data, which can take up to 5 GB of data on your drive. This is unnecessary space. Not only can CleanMyMac shrink the individual snapshots that Time Machine has taken of your drive, it can delete some of the temporary storage time stamps.

You can go ahead and “Run Tasks” on the main screen (*fig 5.2*) to thin your Time Machine Snapshot.

Reindex Spotlight will rebuilt the macOS Spotlight’s search index so your Mac can search files, emails, apps, and documents accurately and quickly. The Mac’s internal index for spotlight can become corrupted over time, out of date, slow, or inaccurate. CleanMyMac force deletes the old index, and makes your device create a new one expediting future search tasks that you may initialize. Rest assured, the **Reindex Spotlight** feature ensures all drives and volumes are indexed correctly during this process.

The other maintenance task here worth learning about is flushing the DNS cache. This procedure clears your laptop’s internal DNS (**domain name system**) lookup memory so the computer can correctly load websites and network services. DNS converts website names (links) into IP addresses for internet browsing purposes. While the intention of storing a DNS is to speed up browsing, corrupted or outdated IP addresses need to be deleted from its cache. An overstuffed DNS cache can cause websites not to load or websites loading incorrectly. This function can improve internet responsiveness if DNS overflow was the cause of the slowdown.

Now that you know what the software is doing, click “Run” to perform all necessary maintenance tasks.

After 2 minutes, you should arrive at this screen. Good to know your system has undergone useful maintenance with the helping hand of CleanMyMac.

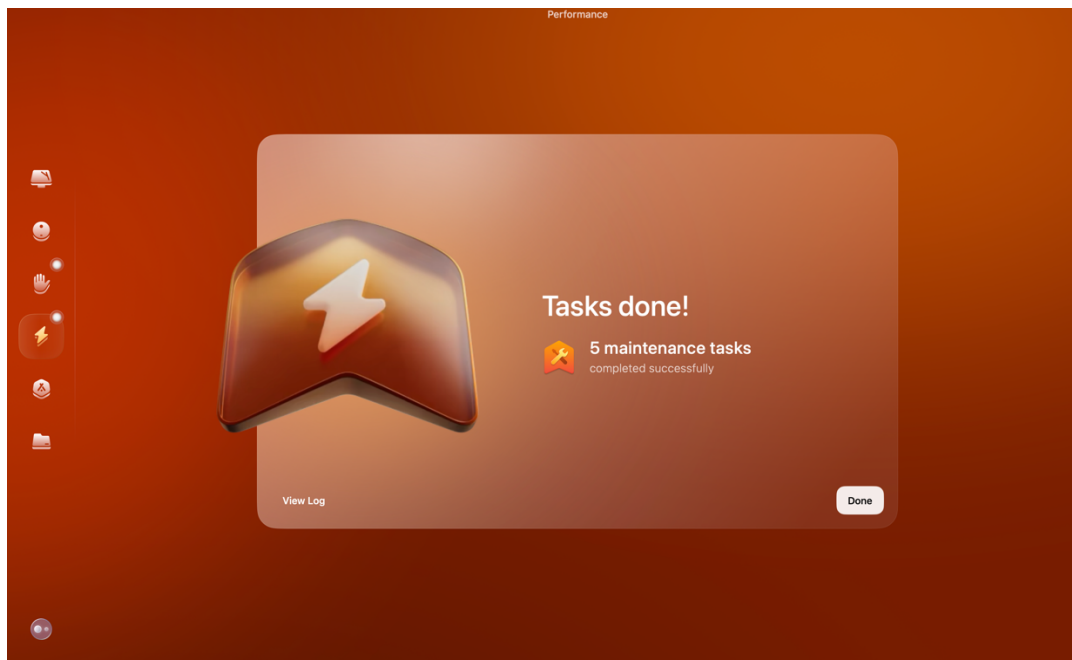


fig. 5.4

You can also remove Background Items that are processes that are unnecessary or representing apps or software that you don't use often. For example, I removed a Microsoft updater and .plist file (storing user settings for Microsoft apps on my laptop). Since these were running in the background I can assume the .plist file is only the most recent snapshot of my user settings, and can be done away with as unnecessary. I use Microsoft Word, but I recently updated the app. Why keep things running in the background if there's no point?

6. Explore **decluttering** abilities of CleanMyMac

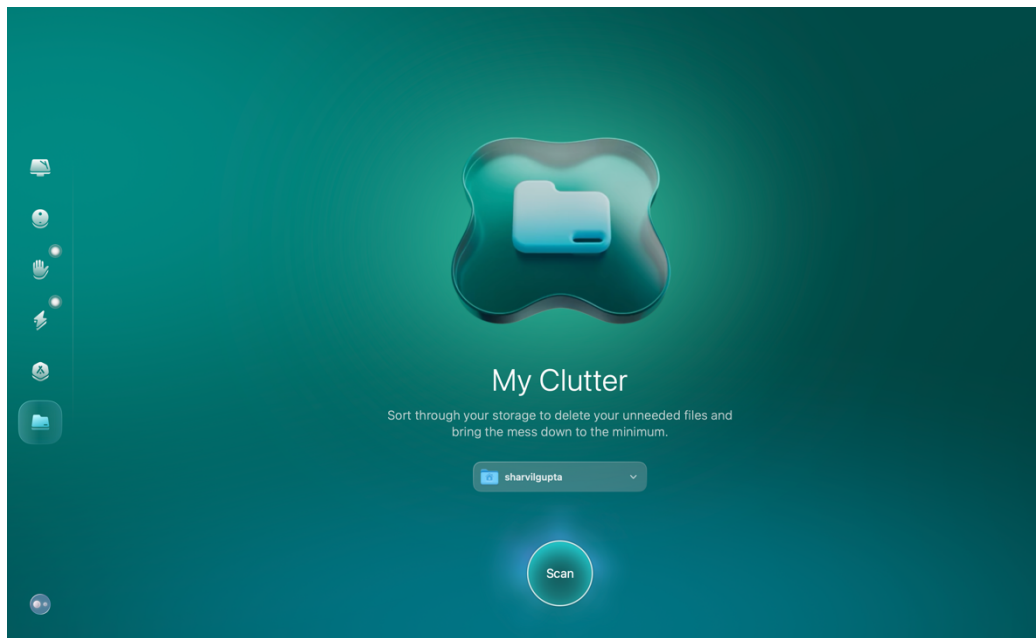


fig. 6.1

1. Go to the sidebar and click on “My Clutter”
2. It will ask you which main drive to scan
3. Click on the “Scan” button (*fig. 6.1*)
4. Your screen should look like *fig. 6.2*

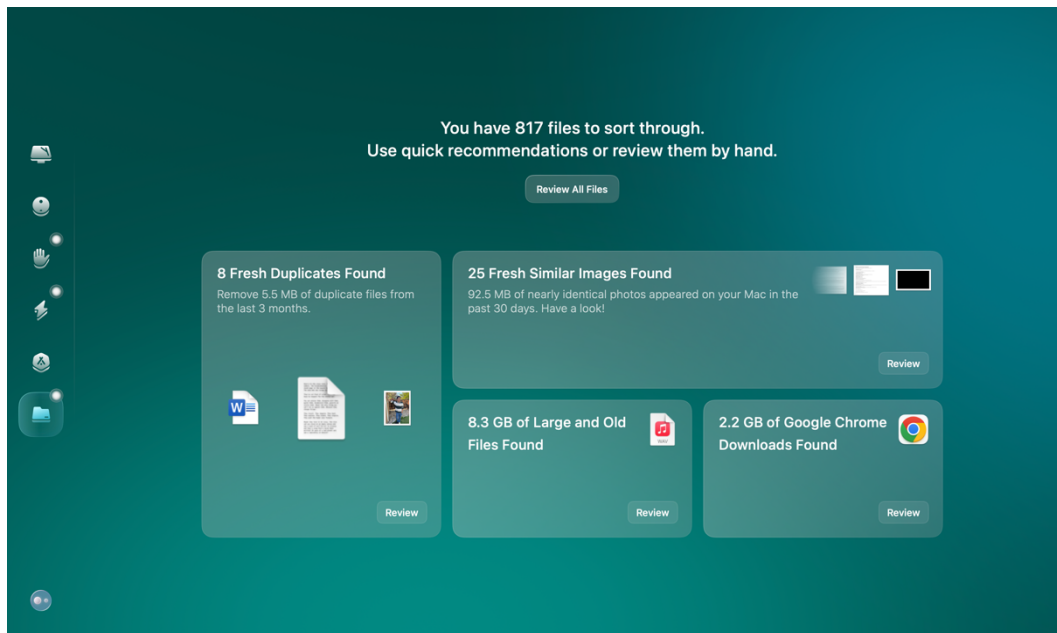


fig. 6.2

5. Think about clearing your drive of duplicate files. You can review them carefully. You can also look through “25 Fresh Similar Images” to consider deleting.
6. You can also check out “Large and Old Files” for any space you seek to clear.
7. Review your “Google Chrome Downloads” before decluttering through review too.
8. I reviewed all my clutter and decided against de-cluttering my laptop.

7. Use “Clean Up” mode

Smart Scan takes care of most of your cleanup needs, but if you want a more detailed go at your files, before deleting them to make room on your hard drive, you can use the sidebar “Clean Up” mode too, but this is optional.

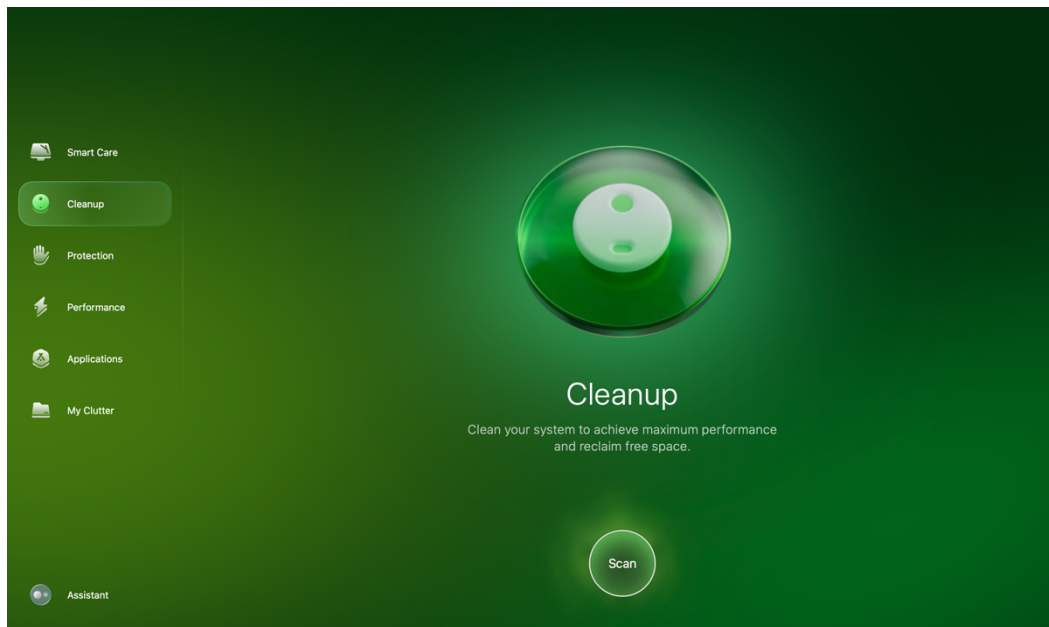


fig. 7.1

1. Hit the scan button (*fig. 7.1*)
2. A screen like *fig. 7.2* should come up and allow you to free any extra space you had on your drive that “Smart Scan” didn’t catch.

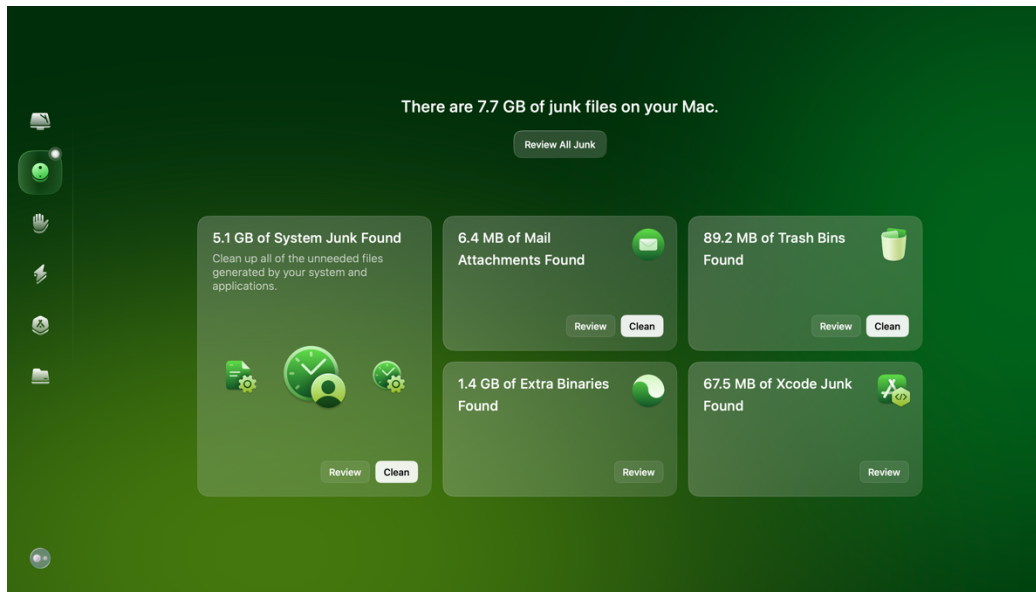


fig. 7.2

Review the “5.1” GB of System Junk found and delete it. CleanMyMac does a good job distinguishing between files you need and don’t need.

Here you’ll find system cache files, temporary system logs, broken system preferences, old system reports, app cache files, update leftovers, support files from uninstalled apps, browser junk, error logs, and diagnostic logs.

3. Go into “Universal Binaries” let’s see what’s going on there. Click on “Review”

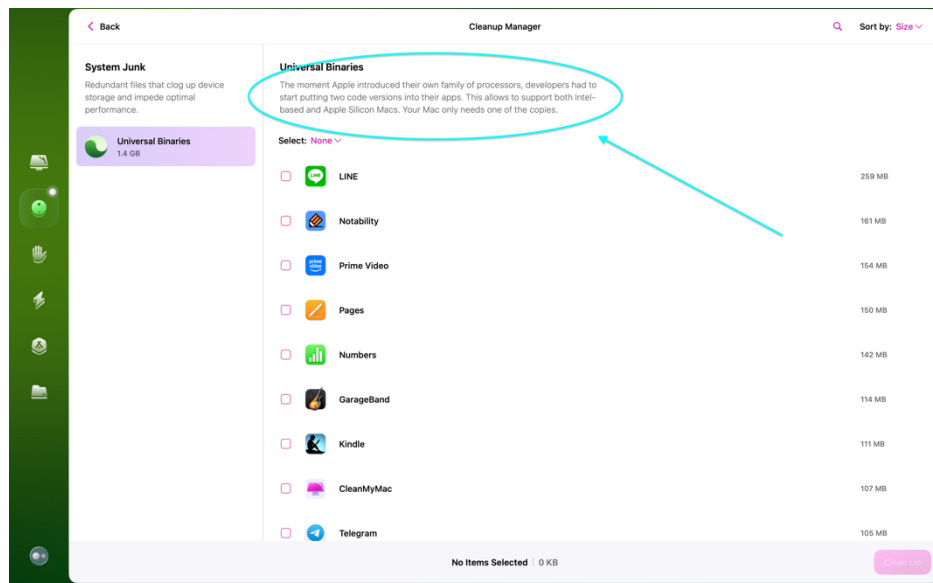


fig. 7.3

CleanMyMac does a great job explaining that these Universal Binaries were originally created by developers who needed to put two copies of code into their apps and so having an Intel-based or Apple Silicon Mac means you don't need the other copy of code that exists on your drive (*fig. 7.3*).

8. Uninstall Applications

This is one of my favorite features of CleanMyMac since it allows for a clean uninstalling operation to take care of those leftover files and bits of data stored on your drive that may have otherwise been overlooked by different uninstalling software or you trying to uninstall the application manually.

While scanning the software mentions it's looking through “applications, updates, and leftovers”

1. Click the “Scan” button (*fig. 8.1*)

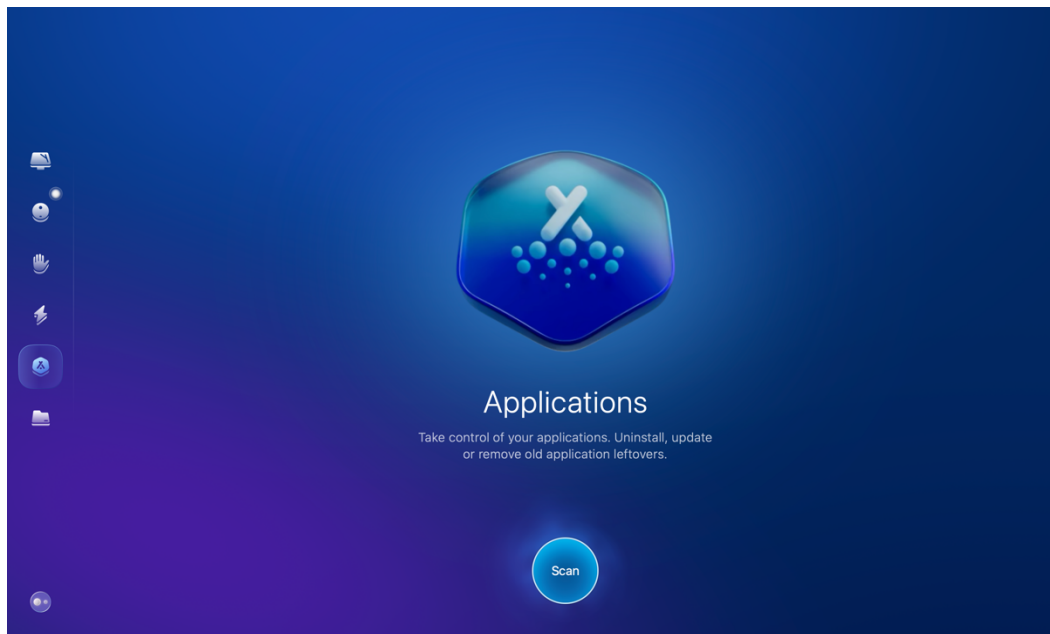


fig. 8.1

2. I'm going to not only update all my apps today but "Review" some of my unused applications.

Updating your applications is a good way to make sure they are running optimally and don't have any bugs. This also means that the applications do as they are supposed to do and function with new software updates, obviously making the whole thing niftier and more organized towards higher function in whatever it is that you're trying to do. Developers are always making updates to their software, so as to make things more convenient, intuitive, intelligent, and comprehensive in catering to all your task-oriented needs. We don't express gratitude enough for the tasks that technology on our Mac helps us get through in a day. Guess we have the folks at Apple to thank.

Object oriented programming is one of the many ways that Apple utilizes **coding** languages like Python to do whatever it is they do on the software development side of things. There were some deleted code samples, that surfaced earlier in the "Clean Up" section of this manual. If you jog your memory, Intel and Apple Silicon based chips. Quite the name for this kind of technology, if I may say so myself. Anyways, if you'll remember there's a superfluous version of a software or application's **code** loaded up on your system for no reason.

As far as using a software like "Notability" shining as the primary ulterior app I'm using, could be used to take notes at a medical appointment, sobriety group meeting, board game night journaling, or just writing a poem after an exciting time with a friend. Also take notes in class for sure, for those pursuing higher education in college classrooms. It's possible to get parts of a degree from online Zoom lessons, which is crazy to think about these days. But nothing can replace the feeling you get, when your feet are grounded in an actual classroom, in real life listening to a lecture on your favorite subject, like Plato's *The Cave*.

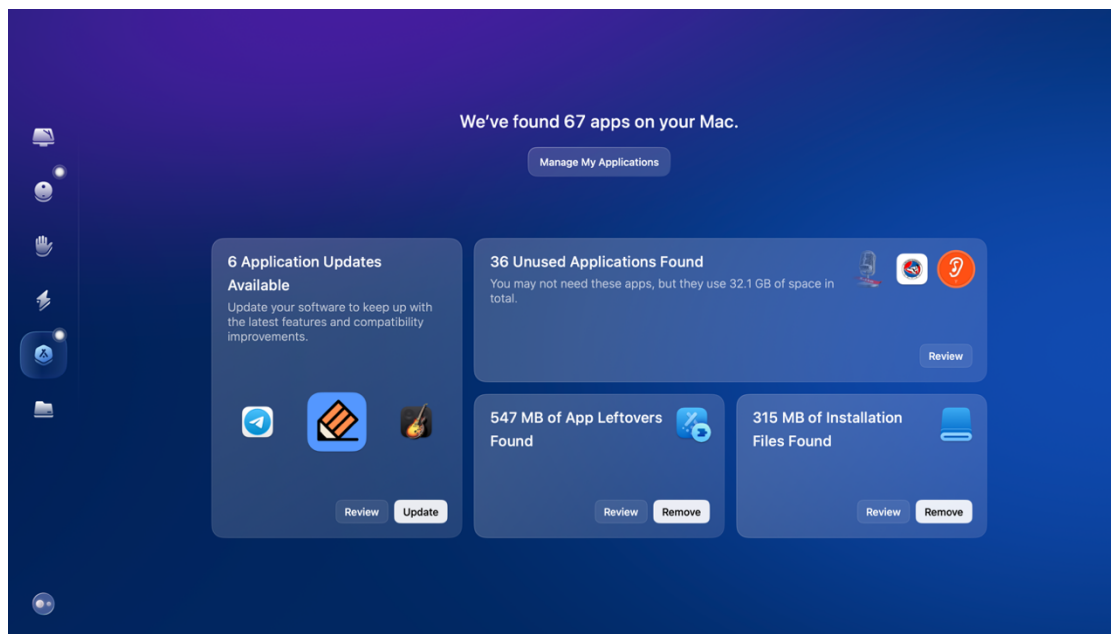


fig. 8.2

Let's uninstall an ear training app that I won't be using. I had taken a trial version of their software to see if my musical mind was fascinated by identifying notes and chords by hearing them to attain perfect pitch.

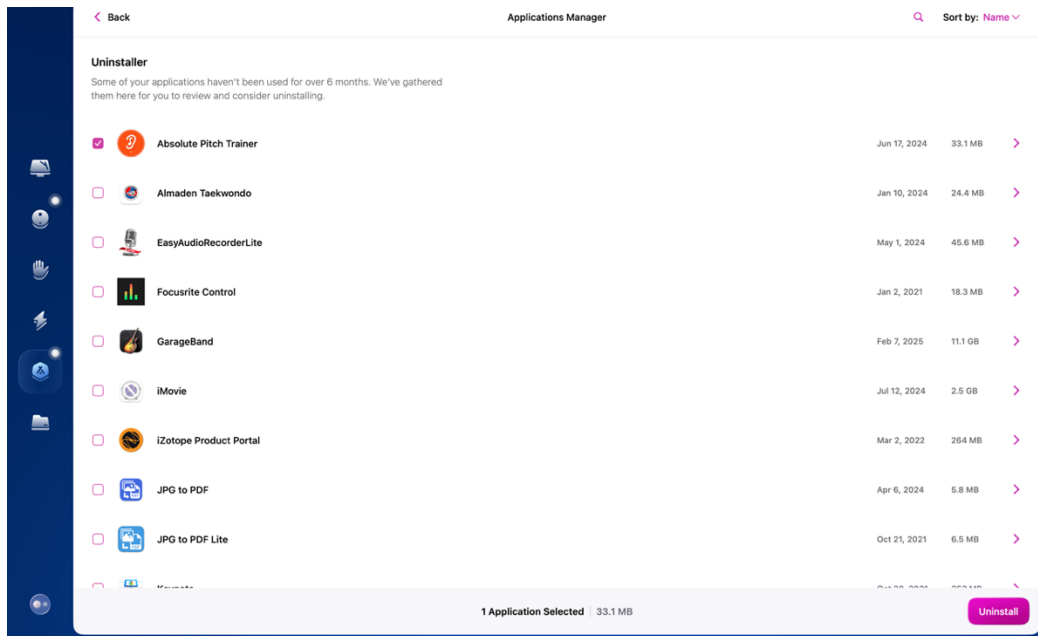


fig. 8.3

Click “Uninstall” and contemplate losing this app from your device forever temporarily. Move to the next thought and hold on tight as you discover that the operation has been completed.

The CleanMyMac engine has successfully uninstalled “Absolute Pitch Trainer” and its binaries and containers.